

HÜSEYİN YURTSEVEN

Senior Engineering & Science Leader | Machine Learning & Personalization

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Accomplished engineering and science executive with 20+ years of software development experience and 10+ years leading high-performance engineering and science teams at scale, including organizations of 160+ people and two R&D centres in Turkey. Proven cross-functional leader across engineering and science functions — building and scaling organizations of Applied Scientists, Machine Learning Engineers, and Data Scientists that deliver measurable business impact. Building and leading data science teams since 2015, with repeated success transforming functional data science organizations into cross-functional data product setups (Delivery Hero, Trendyol). Track record of success across startups and large-scale enterprises (Amazon, Alibaba Group, Delivery Hero), building cross-functional organizations with clear independent value streams, strategic domain-driven design approaches, and empowered team topologies that optimize for autonomy, ownership, and fast flow of delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Amazon / Amazon Music

Senior Software Development Manager, Amazon Music Machine Learning & Managing Director, Snackable OÜ (Estonia) *January 2023 - Present | Berlin, Germany*

Lead 3 globally distributed cross-functional teams of 30+ Applied Scientists, Machine Learning Engineers, and Software Development Engineers within Amazon Music Personalization organization across Berlin and Tallinn.

- Direct leadership of 3 teams: Customer Intelligence (Tallinn), Content Expertise (Berlin), and Candidate Intelligence (Berlin)
 - Own the Domain Intelligence platform — the core personalization-as-a-service layer powering customer understanding, content expertise, and intelligent candidate retrieval
 - Drive strategic technical initiatives in personalization algorithms, ranking systems, and customer behavior modeling
 - Architect scalable ML systems serving millions of Amazon Music customers globally
 - Collaborate with product, science, and engineering leadership on roadmap and technical strategy
 - Establish engineering and science excellence practices, mentoring senior engineers and applied scientists
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Trendyol / Alibaba Group

Head of Engineering & Managing Director, Germany Office *December 2021 - January 2023 | Istanbul, Turkey & Berlin, Germany*

Led engineering organization for the local commerce vertical (Trendyol Go, later acquired by Uber), managing 17+ teams across logistics, assortment, and store operations. Concurrently served as Managing Director of Trendyol's Germany office, overseeing local operations and market expansion.

- Established organizational structure and team topologies optimizing for autonomy and delivery velocity
- Served on tribe leadership group, shaping company-wide technical strategy
- Led Trendyol's Germany office as Managing Director, driving market presence and operational setup
- Transformed the functional data science organization into a cross-functional data product setup, embedding data scientists into domain teams
- Partnered with data engineering and data science teams to build data-driven capabilities
- Introduced OKR framework, Executive Action Team, and RFC/ADR processes
- Transformed organization to outcome-driven, empowered team model

Technologies: Python, FastAPI, Golang, React, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Microservices, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, AWS, GCP

Delivery Hero SE

Director, Software Engineering *July 2020 - December 2021 | Berlin, Germany*

Led Q-Commerce engineering tribe, managing managers of managers, senior data science managers, and engineering teams.

- Directed engineering organization including platform teams, data science teams, and product engineering
- Transitioned the functional data science organization into a cross-functional data product setup
- Launched comprehensive Product Information Management (PIM) system
- Redesigned team structure resulting in measurable improvements in delivery velocity and quality
- Implemented OKR methodology across tribe, aligning engineering efforts with business outcomes
- Developed multi-criteria ranking solution improving search relevance

Technologies: Python, FastAPI, Golang, React, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Microservices, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, AWS, GCP

Kariyer.net

Chief Technology Officer *February 2020 - July 2020 | Istanbul, Turkey*

Led technology organization of Turkey's premier job board and ATS platforms, leading the organization as an R&D centre and managing 80+ engineers, data scientists, DevOps engineers, and QA professionals.

- Directed all engineering, R&D, DevOps, and QA functions across multiple product lines
- Established software architecture standards and scalability principles for high-traffic platforms
- Implemented OKR and Agile methodologies across engineering organization

Technologies: .NET Core, Python, React, Next.js, Vue.js, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Microservices, Azure

BluTV

Chief Technology Officer *April 2018 - February 2020 | Istanbul, Turkey*

Led technology vision for Turkey's leading OTT streaming platform (later acquired by Discovery), managing 40+ engineers, data scientists, and DevOps professionals.

- Directed end-to-end technology development for OTT platform serving millions of users
- Built in-house capabilities across video delivery, DRM, recommendation systems, and content management
- Developed proprietary streaming infrastructure supporting HLS, MPEG-DASH, and multi-DRM
- Built in-house data science team and ML-powered recommendation and personalization systems, driving content discovery and engagement

Technologies: Python, React, scikit-learn, Microservices, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, HLS, MPEG-DASH, DRM, AWS

Dogan TV

Director of Software Development and Technical Innovation *September 2015 - April 2018 | Istanbul, Turkey*

Led the group's R&D centre — a 70+ person engineering and data science organization across multiple media properties and platforms.

- Drove Dogan TV's transformation into an R&D centre — built and led the company's first data science team
- Established the company's first Hadoop cluster and built its first recommendation systems
- Architected Hadoop-based ML systems for recommendation, churn prediction (powering pay-TV subscriber retention), and audience segmentation
- Directed development of headless CMS (Blupoint CMS) — including ML-based image matching — plus eCRM, DRM systems, and custom CDN solutions
- Processed and analyzed clickstream and video event data from 40+ platforms

Platform Portfolio: blutv.com.tr, netd.com, kanald.com.tr, cnnturk.com, dsmart.com.tr

Technologies: Python, Vue.js, scikit-learn, Microservices, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Hadoop, DRM technologies

Previous roles at Dogan TV: - Software Development and Technical Innovation Manager (2014 - 2015) - netd.com — Software Development Manager (2012 - 2014) - cnnturk.com — Software Development Manager (2009 - 2012) - cnnturk.com — Senior Software Developer (2008 - 2009)

PUBLICATIONS

Generalized Position-Based Model: Rethinking Position Weights in Ranking Off-Policy Evaluation Vito Bellini, Norman Knyazev, Huseyin Yurtseven, Ben London | ACM RecSys 2026

A Unified Recommendation Model for Features Summarization Vito Bellini, Zhan Shi, Huseyin Yurtseven, Fabian Moerchen, Emanuele Coviello | RecSys 2025 Workshop on Music Recommender Systems | Amazon Science | <https://www.amazon.science/publications/a-unified-recommendation-model-for-features-summarization>

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Leadership: Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Organizational Design, Strategic Planning, OKR Implementation, Agile Methodologies

AI/ML: Machine Learning, Recommendation Systems, Personalization, Ranking Algorithms, Churn Prediction, Customer Segmentation, Deep Learning, MLOps

Engineering: Distributed Systems, Microservices, Python, Golang, Java, JavaScript/TypeScript, React, Cloud (AWS, GCP, Azure)

Data: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Redis, Data Pipeline Architecture

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Physics | Istanbul University | 2000 - 2005

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- AWS Solution Architect (2018)
 - Deep Learning (2018)
 - Kubernetes (2017)
 - Machine Learning (2013)
 - Project Management and PMP Preparation (2012)
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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: Turkish (Native), English (Fluent) **Location:** Berlin, Germany **Work Authorization:** Permanent Residency

More about my leadership philosophy: <https://hyurtseven81.github.io/>